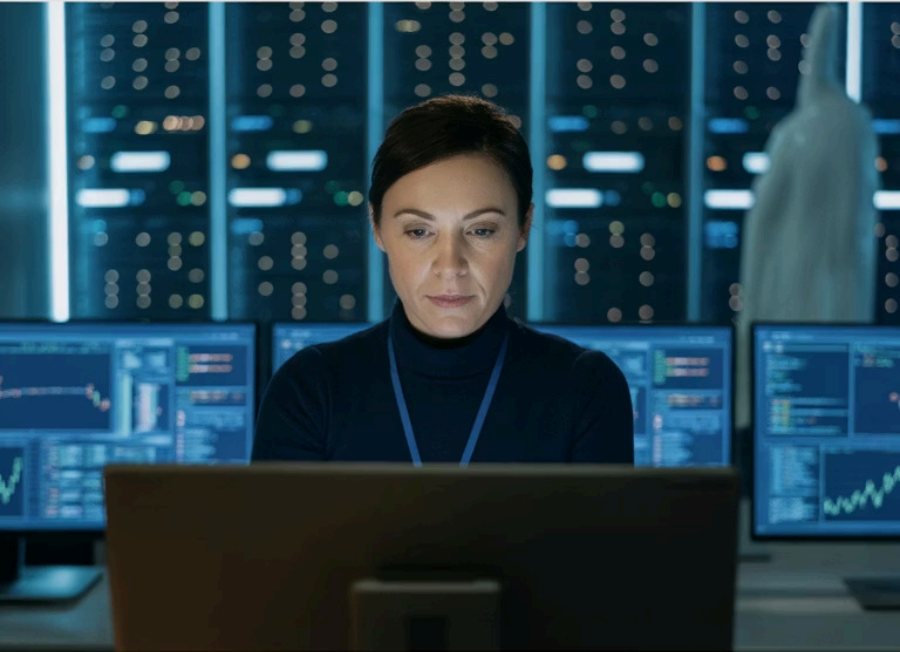


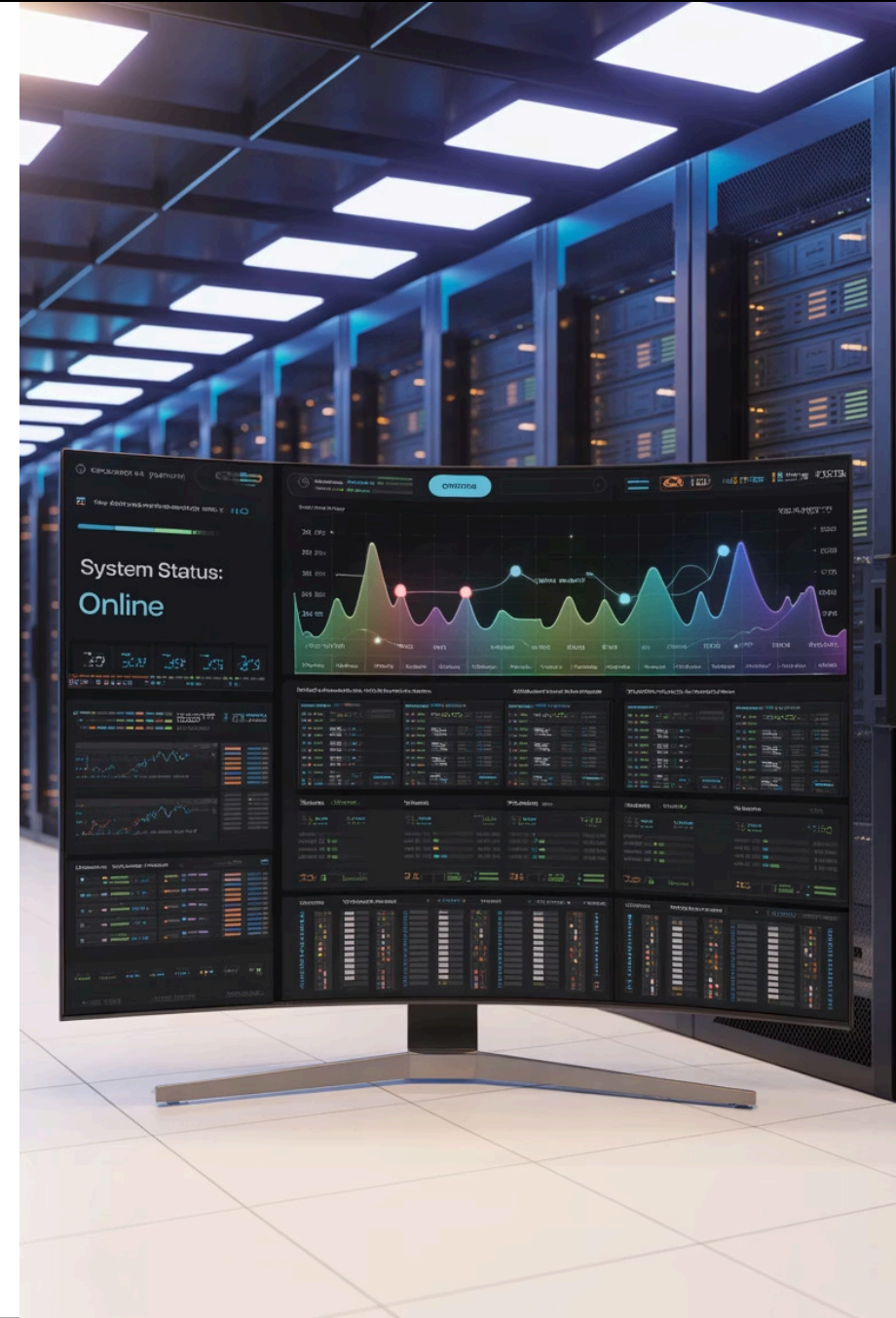


Pager Rotation Duties – Best Practices in DevOps

Julio Pochet ▪ CSD-380 ▪ Module 7.2

Why Pager Duty Matters

- Systems don't sleep, so someone has to be available 24/7
- Fast response = less downtime for users
- Keeps teams accountable and breaks down the "Dev vs Ops" wall
- On-call is more than firefighting — it's about learning from incidents



Fair Rotations

Primary + backup so one person isn't stuck alone

Rotate nights/weekends evenly

Allow swaps so people can still have a life

Fair rotations = less burnout, happier engineers



Shift Length & Handoffs

01

Avoid marathon 24-hour shifts

03

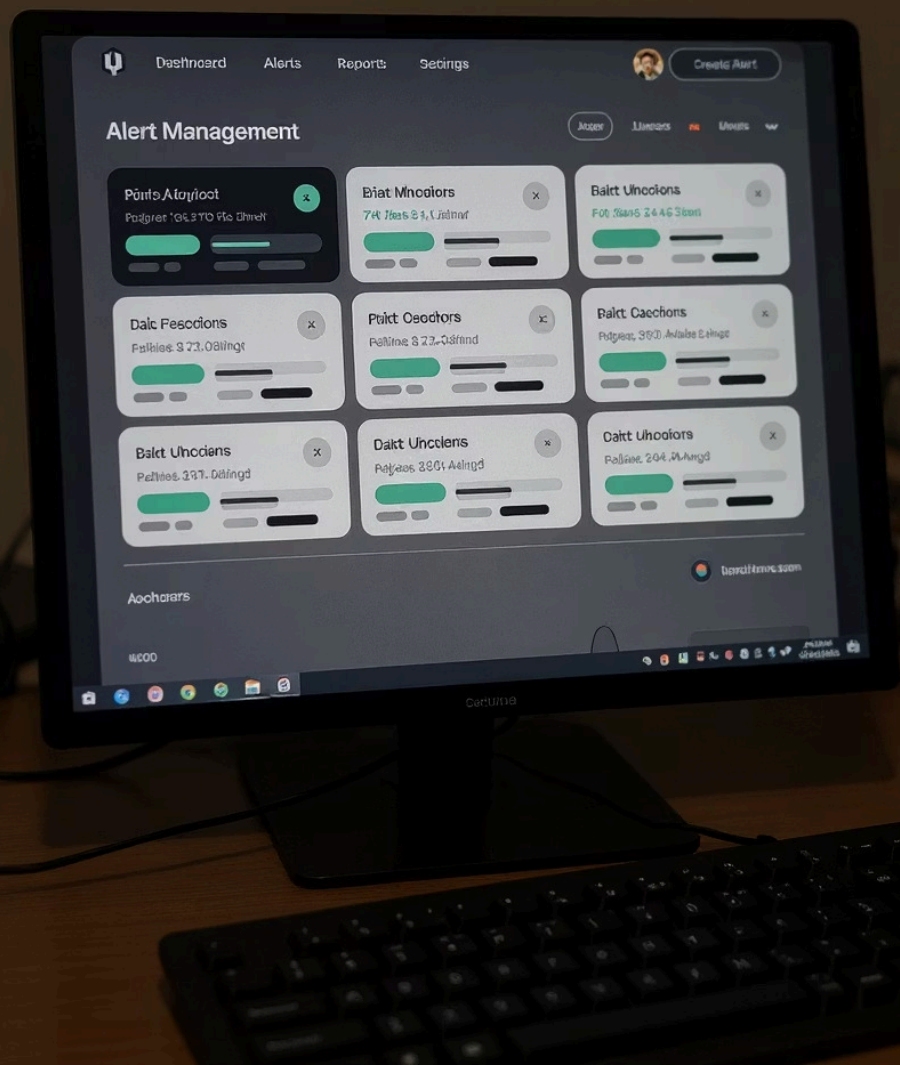
Quick handoff meetings → share open issues and risks

02

**Stick to consistent schedules
(weekly shifts work best)**

04

Monday reviews close the loop on last week's incidents



Alert Hygiene (Fighting Noise)

Only alert if action is needed right away

Low-priority issues can wait until business hours

Tune thresholds and silence "flapping" alerts

Review alerts monthly: what's useful vs. what's just spam

Runbooks & Tools



Updated runbooks = faster fixes



Automate safe/common tasks where possible



Test paging paths and devices often



On-call kit ready: laptop, VPN, phone charger

Protecting Team Health



Track number of pages per person → redistribute if unfair



Comp time for heavy weeks = less resentment



Blameless reviews after incidents → fix systems, not people



Healthy teams = better reliability long-term

Patterns That Work



"Follow-the-sun" → use global time zones, no one always stuck at 3 a.m.



"Round-robin escalation" → spreads pages in a shift



Teams owning their services → more accountability and faster fixes



My Recommendations

1

Primary + backup always

2

Handoffs on Mondays with a 10-minute check-in

3

Tiered alerts (critical = page, minor = dashboard)

4

Keep runbooks fresh and drill paging paths quarterly

5

Track burnout and give people recovery time

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